

The US Admissions Profile Checklist

Rate yourself 1-5 across every dimension top US universities evaluate

■ Academic Excellence

Area	Question	Score (1–5)	Notes
GPA / Predicted Grades	Are your grades consistently strong across all subjects?	___/5	
Course Rigor	Are you taking the hardest available courses (AP/IB/Honours)?	___/5	
Class Rank	Do you rank in the top 10% of your class?	___/5	
Upward Trend	Are your grades improving over time?	___/5	
Subject Depth	Do you show deep strength in your intended major's subjects?	___/5	

■ Extracurricular Activities

Area	Question	Score (1–5)	Notes
Leadership Roles	Do you hold a leadership position in any club or organisation?	___/5	
Consistency	Have you committed to activities for 2+ years?	___/5	
Impact & Initiative	Have you created or grown something, not just participated?	___/5	
Awards & Recognition	Have you won any competitions, olympiads, or received honours?	___/5	
Passion Projects	Do you have a self-directed project that shows genuine curiosity?	___/5	

■ Research & Intellectual Curiosity

Area	Question	Score (1–5)	Notes
Independent Research	Have you conducted research beyond your school curriculum?	___/5	
Publications / Presentations	Have you published, presented, or submitted work?	___/5	
Internship / Work Experience	Do you have relevant real-world experience in your field?	___/5	
Online Courses / Certifications	Have you pursued learning outside of school?	___/5	

■ Essays & Personal Narrative

Area	Question	Score (1–5)	Notes
Authentic Voice	Does your personal statement sound like you — not a template?	___/5	

Specific & Vivid	Are your essays filled with concrete details and moments? ___/5	
Theme Consistency	Do your essays connect to a coherent personal narrative? ___/5	
Supplemental Essays	Have you written strong, school-specific supplemental essays? ___/5	

■ Recommendations

Area	Question	Score (1-5)	Notes
Teacher Relationships	Do you have strong relationships with 2+ teachers?	___/5	
Counsellor Recommendation	Does your counsellor know your story and achievements?	___/5	
Quality of Letters	Will your recommenders write specific, enthusiastic letters?	___/5	

■ Community & Service

Area	Question	Score (1-5)	Notes
Service Hours	Have you volunteered or served your community consistently? ___/5		
Impact	Can you quantify the impact of your community work? ___/5		
Cultural Context	Have you shown awareness of and engagement with broader issues? ___/5		

■ Score Interpretation

Total Score	Profile Strength	Recommendation
85 – 100	Exceptional	Apply to Top 20 universities confidently
70 – 84	Strong	Target Top 50, with selective reaches
55 – 69	Developing	Focus on 1-2 areas to strengthen before applying
Below 55	Needs Work	Spend 6-12 months building before applying